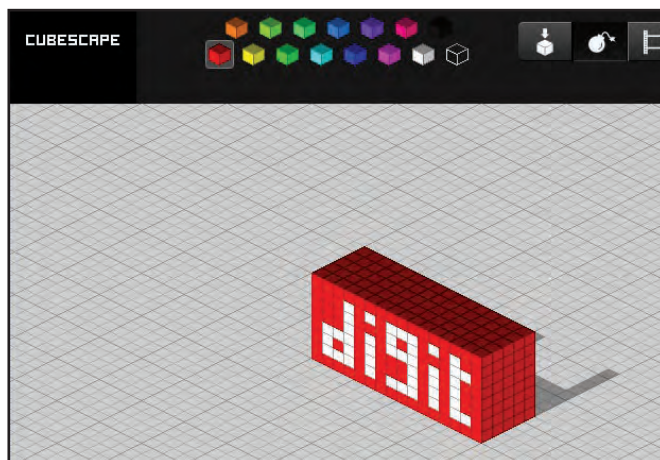




Move over robot dogs, Pleo is here

What's better than a robot dog that jumps around and listens to instructions? A pretty realistic robot dinosaur, that's what. Pleo was showcased at CES this year, and ambles around on his saurapod legs when not playing with your kid. We just wish there were life sized fire breathing versions in the market

Cubescape



Cubescape is a great AJAX based web site that let's you drop cubes in a field. This let's you come up with elaborate isometric art, depending on how much time you are willing to spend on it. Till recently, users could save their creations, and people could browse through them. That functionality has been recently disabled, although there are a few great creations still searchable through Google images. Depth can be very misleading in Isometric art, as everything actually looks the same distance from the viewer; what you see above is not a solid block for example. Look carefully at the shadows, and you will see a hole in the block. Once you have created a cubescape, you can play it back.



tech art: Microchip art

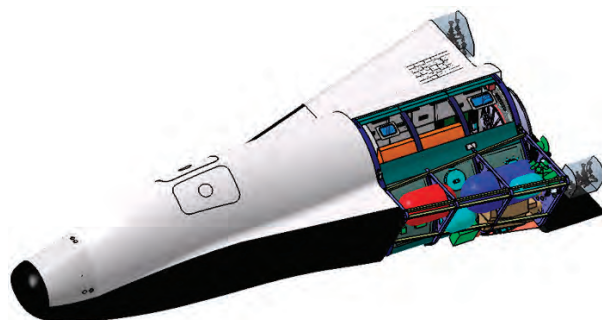
The next time you look at all the lines and blips on a circuit board, don't think all of it is there for a reason. There are loads of ICs with small, invisible designs on them, ranging from fire breathing Godzilla's to really tiny Rams. If you want to discover these on ICs that you find, you will have to look using a really powerful magnifying glass. Just make sure that the sun is not behind you when you are hunting though. Microchip art does serve a purpose however; they are there to make sure that no one copies the design, as copied designs will have a flag in the form of the chip art as well. This makes sure that piracy in the silicon manufacturing industry is sure to be caught. We just wonder if manufacturers of all kinds of silicone products mark them in some way.

NEWS

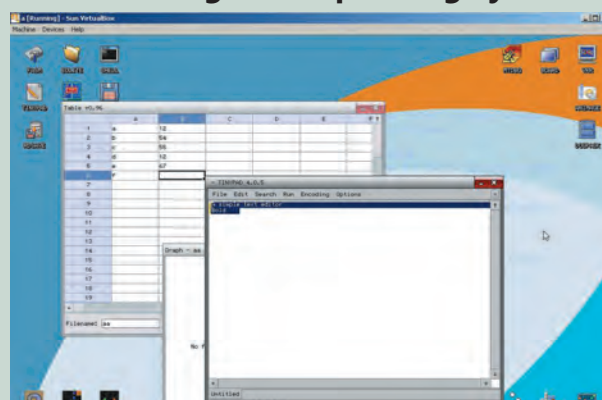
Shuttle engines at throwaway prices

After decades of space adventures, the engines that drove the NASA shuttles are being thrown away. As long as you can pay for the shipping and handling, you can pick one of the three remaining shuttle engines for free. This is because the Shuttle program is being replaced with the Ares V launch craft, which is a more streamlined vehicle that looks a bit like the Russian Soyuz. This is a rare case where the streamlined version does not look as awesome, but are probably safer. The Lockheed craft have wings that are really retracted, and look a tad better (shown below).

It's not the engines that are up for sale. If you have around US\$30 Million lying around in the pockets of an old discarded jacket, you can pick up Discovery, Endeavour and Atlantis. Not all three of them, just one. Don't dream of space travel though, as the engines are being removed. At least don't dream of space travel and expect to come back. We are pretty sure that the shuttles will not leave the United States though.



The amazing 3MB Operating System



Kolibri desktop is a small 3MB Operating System, that is written entirely in machine code (CPU Language) and is not based on Linux, Windows or any other variants. What is surprising is the number of applications packed into this tiny file size. There are a whole bunch of games, a basic tables editor, a compiler, a text editor, a bouquet of demos, a text based web browser and more. There is also DosBox, which let's you run almost any DOS game on Kolibri. While not meant for serious use, the tiny OS shows how bloated Windows and Linux really are.